

Preparing Your Home for TPLO Recovery

A practical owner-to-owner checklist for thinking through daily life before surgery.

Recovery space

- Choose a location where your dog can rest without feeling isolated.
- Confirm the enclosure is large enough for your dog, bed, cone, and water.
- Check floor traction inside the space and along every bathroom route.
- Provide a stable resting surface and a safe cooler option.
- Place water where a cone will not make drinking unnecessarily difficult.
- Keep fans, cords, and cameras outside reach.

Movement and access

- Plan how your dog will get outside.
- Decide how stairs will be blocked, assisted, or avoided.
- Plan safe car loading and unloading.
- Block or manage furniture that may invite jumping.
- Identify every place your dog normally rests—including stairs and landings.

The whole household

- Plan how other pets will move around the recovery area.
- Think through meals, walks, visitors, deliveries, storms, and fireworks.
- Choose a visible location for the cone and other must-use equipment.
- Write down who can help if lifting or transportation becomes difficult.

Before pickup

- Organize the written veterinary instructions.
- Create one medication chart from the actual labels and instructions.
- Prepare food, water, leash, sling or harness if prescribed, and a bathroom route.
- Save the veterinary clinic and emergency numbers where they are easy to find.

Use this with the instructions from your own veterinary team. It is an owner-planning tool, not veterinary advice.